

The Mystery in the Storybook

A bit of a stretch · Indoors · Kid can lead · Ages 7–11 · 35 min

Brought to you by Yuna — “Every good adventure starts on a page.”

Write a mystery about something missing, then build the tool your detective needs to solve it.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Paper for the story
- Pencil and markers
- Card for a clue-finder
- Optional: a magnifying glass

BEFORE YOU START

If you use a real magnifying glass, never point it at the sun.

How to make it

- 1 Decide what has gone missing. Make it small and oddly specific: a golden leaf, a left shoe, a key that opens nothing.
- 2 Write down three characters. One of them knows something they have not said.
- 3 Plant three clues. Two should point somewhere useful and one should point the wrong way on purpose.
- 4 Build a clue-finder from card: a frame, a handle, and a window you look through.
- 5 Write the ending last. The solution has to use at least two of your clues.
- 6 Read it aloud to someone and stop before the ending. Let them guess first.

TALK ABOUT IT

Your false clue sent the reader the wrong way. Why does a mystery need one?

TRY THIS TOO

Give the same three clues to a friend and let them write a completely different ending.

DID YOU KNOW? · NATURE & ANIMALS

Leaves catch sunlight and turn it into food. A leaf is a solar panel with a job. It takes sunlight, water, and air, and makes the sugar the tree needs to grow. That is why leaves are wide and flat, and why a tree in shade grows slowly.